

Subject: Reference Letter for Ashwin Yadhav Kumar – PhD Application

To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to provide this reference in support of Ashwin Yadhav Kumar's application for a PhD programme at the University of Exeter.

I had the opportunity to supervise Ashwin during his MSc in Business Analytics at the University of Exeter, including his dissertation research, which later progressed towards academic publication. During this period, Ashwin demonstrated strong analytical capability, intellectual curiosity, and a highly interdisciplinary approach towards problem solving.

What particularly stood out throughout his academic work was his ability to connect technical analytical methods with practical real-world implementation challenges. His dissertation reflected not only quantitative and predictive analytical understanding, but also maturity in strategic thinking, operational reasoning, and research development.

Ashwin consistently showed initiative beyond the standard expectations of postgraduate study. He was proactive in refining his research ideas, receptive to academic feedback, and capable of independently exploring complex topics across multiple disciplines. His professional background prior to joining Exeter also brought valuable practical perspective into his academic work.

The proposed PhD topic he is pursuing - focusing on behavioural healthcare, personalised nutrition, predictive analytics, and preventative healthcare systems - strongly aligns with both his analytical strengths and his demonstrated ability to work across interdisciplinary domains.

In my opinion, Ashwin possesses the motivation, resilience, and research capability required to undertake doctoral-level study successfully. I believe he would contribute positively to both the academic and collaborative research environment at Exeter.

I therefore **strongly support his application** and would recommend him for consideration without hesitation.

Yours sincerely,

Professor Dr Konstantinos Nikolopoulos M. Eng. & D.Eng. ([EMII](#)/[NTUA](#)),

ITP ([Northwestern](#))

Associate Dean Internationalisation, [Durham University Business School](#)

Co-Director, [Institute of Hazard, Risk and Resilience](#)

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